

mount the file system:

```
$ mkdir /virtual-fs
```

```
$ mount -o loop=/dev/loop0 /tmp/disk-image /virtual-fs
```



Note: If you want to mount multiple devices, you will have to increase the loop count as mentioned below:

```
loop=/dev/loop1, loop=/dev/loop2, ... loop=/dev/loopn
```

After you complete the above steps, you can use it as a virtual file system. You can even add this to `/etc/fstab` to mount this virtual file system whenever your computer is rebooted.

Open your `/etc/fstab` in a text editor and add the following:

```
/tmp/disk-image /virtual-fs ext3 rw,loop=/dev/loop0 0 0
```

—Aarsh S Talati,
aarshstlati1989@gmail.com

Identify your current shell name



You can identify your current shell name by using the following commands:

```
[narendra@CentOS]$ echo $SHELL
```

```
/bin/bash
```

The “`$SHELL`” environment variable stores the name of the current shell.

You can also use the command given below to get the shell name:

```
[narendra@CentOS]$ echo $0
```

```
bash
```

“`$0`” will print the name of the program; here the program name is ‘current shell’.

—Narendra Kangralkar,
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Scan open ports



The command given below will scan all the open TCP ports on the loopback interface:

```
nmap -sS -O 127.0.0.1
```

In general, you can use the following:

```
nmap -sS -O
```

To scan open UDP ports in the system, use the command given below:

```
nmap -sU -O
```

—Prasanna,

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Rev up!



As *nix sysadmins, we need to do a whole bunch of text-based data processing, either in files or data streams.

Here is a shell command called `rev` that I came across and wanted to share with you geeks because I really liked it and found it useful.

The `rev` command utility reverses the order of characters in every line. In short, it creates a mirror image. The most common use of `rev` is to reverse the line, extract a particular string and then pipe through `rev` a second time to restore the original.

So, if I want to get the year mentioned at the end of a string, this is what I will do:

```
$cat fileinfo.txt
```

```
Last Changed Date: 2011-08-11 18:10:08 -0500 Thu, 11 Aug 2011
```

```
$cat fileinfo.txt | rev
```

```
1102 guA 11 ,uHT 0050- 00:01:01 11-08-1102 :eta0 degnahC tsal
```

```
$cat fileinfo.txt | rev | awk '{print $1}'  
1102
```

```
$cat fileinfo.txt | rev | awk '{print $1}' | rev  
2011
```

Voila! Got the year! This is just one workaround, out of the many ways of doing this same task. After all, it doesn't hurt to learn something new.

—Ram Iyer,
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END

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